

Memory

- Memory is the ability to **encode, store, and retrieve** information.
- Psychologists study memory to understand how information is learned, retained, and later accessed.

The Three Basic Processes

- **Encoding:** transforming information into a form that can be stored.
- **Storage:** maintaining information over time.
- **Retrieval:** bringing stored information back when it is needed.

Sensory Memory

- Sensory memory briefly holds information received through the senses.
- It allows the brain to retain a very short record of sights, sounds, and other sensory information.
- Most sensory information disappears quickly unless attention is directed toward it.

Short-Term and Working Memory

- **Short-term memory** holds a limited amount of information for a short period.
- **Working memory** allows information to be temporarily held and manipulated while completing a task.
- Repeating information can help keep it active.

Long-Term Memory

- Long-term memory can store information for much longer periods.
- **Explicit memory** involves information that can be consciously recalled.
- **Implicit memory** influences behavior without requiring conscious recall.

Encoding and Rehearsal

- **Rehearsal** involves repeating information to help maintain it in memory.
- **Elaborative rehearsal** connects new information to knowledge that is already stored.
- Making meaningful connections can make information easier to remember.

Why Do We Forget?

- Forgetting can happen when information was not encoded successfully.
- Memories can also become difficult to retrieve.
- **Interference** occurs when other information makes it harder to remember something.
- New information can interfere with older memories, and older information can interfere with newer learning.

Recall vs. Recognition

- **Recall** requires retrieving information without the same type of direct prompt.
- **Recognition** involves identifying information that has been encountered before.
- Recognition is often easier because the available information provides additional cues.

Memory and Sleep

- Sleep is associated with memory consolidation.
- **Consolidation** is the process through which newly learned information becomes more stable in long-term memory.
- Sleep can therefore play an important role in learning and remembering.

Key Terms

- **Encoding:** converting information into a form that can be stored.
- **Storage:** maintaining information over time.
- **Retrieval:** accessing stored information.
- **Working memory:** temporarily holding and using information.
- **Consolidation:** stabilizing newly learned information.